

CHAPTER 77.

An Act to increase the rate of unemployment benefit payable under the National Insurance (Unemployment) Acts, 1911 to 1918, and to make certain consequential amendments in those Acts. [23rd December 1919.]

BE it enacted by the King's most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows :

1.—(1) The first paragraph of the Seventh Schedule to the National Insurance Act, 1911 (which makes provision with respect to the weekly rate of unemployment benefit), shall have effect as though "eleven shillings" were therein substituted for "seven shillings."

Increase of
rate of unem-
ployment
benefit.
1 & 2 Geo. 5.
c. 8.

(2) The last paragraph of the Seventh Schedule to the National Insurance Act, 1911 (which limits the power to prescribe rates and periods of unemployment benefit), shall have effect as though "twelve shillings" were therein substituted for "eight shillings" and "ten shillings" were therein substituted for "six shillings."

2. Notwithstanding the increase in the rate of unemployment benefit effected by this Act, the expression "which is at least one-third greater than the provision represented by "unemployment benefit under the principal Act" in subsection (1) of section thirteen of the National Insurance (Part II. Unemployment) Act, 1914 (which limits the power to make or continue arrangements with associations under section one hundred and five of the National Insurance Act, 1911), shall, during the period ending on the thirty-first day of December, nineteen hundred and twenty, be construed as meaning which exceeds the provision represented by unemployment benefit at the rate payable after the commencement of this Act by an amount which is not less than one-third of the provision represented by unemployment benefit at the rate payable before the commencement of this Act.

Amendment of
section 13 of
4 & 5 Geo. 5.
c. 57.

3. For the purpose of adapting the provisions of paragraphs (b) and (c) of subsection (1) of section fourteen of the National Insurance (Part II. Amendment) Act, 1914, to the increase in the rate of unemployment benefit effected by this Act the Minister of Labour may, with the consent of the Treasury, make regulations varying the provisions of those paragraphs in such manner as he thinks just.

Amendment of
section 14 of
4 & 5 Geo. 5.
c. 57.

4.—(1) This Act may be cited as the National Insurance (Unemployment) Act, 1919, and the National Insurance

Short title and
commence-
ment

(Unemployment) Acts, 1911 to 1918, and this Act may be cited together as the National Insurance (Unemployment) Acts, 1911 to 1919.

(2) This Act shall come into operation on the Thursday next after the day on which it is passed.

CHAPTER 78.

An Act to confirm certain terms in an Agreement between His Majesty's Government and the Irish Railway Companies. [23rd December 1919.]

34 & 35 Vict.
c. 86.

WHEREAS in pursuance of section sixteen of the Regulation of the Forces Act, 1871, an agreement was made between His Majesty's Government and the Irish Railway Companies whose undertakings were placed under Government control by virtue of an Order in Council dated December 22nd, 1916, issued under the said section sixteen :

And whereas the said agreement contains amongst other provisions those set out in the Schedule to this Act, which provisions require confirmation by Parliament :

Be it therefore enacted by the King's most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows :

Confirmation
of the terms of
agreement.

1. The provisions of the above-recited agreement which are set out in the Schedule to this Act are hereby confirmed, and shall have full force and effect, as from the date of the said agreement, as if enacted in this Act, and any payments under the said agreement and before the passing of this Act which are inconsistent with the terms of the said provisions shall be adjusted so as to give effect to those terms.

Short title.

2. This Act may be cited as the Irish Railways (Confirmation of Agreement) Act, 1919.

Section 1.

SCHEDULE.

EXTRACTS FROM AGREEMENT BETWEEN HIS MAJESTY'S GOVERNMENT AND THE IRISH RAILWAY COMPANIES.

Local rating
authorities
guarantee of
railway divi-
dends, &c.

10. For the purpose of accounts which are prepared by Railway Companies in Ireland in connection with any guarantee of interest, dividend, or working expenses under statutory provisions, the net receipts for the two successive half years of account ended next before first